REALM OF SHADOW

PLAYER'S HANDBOOK

A Player's Guide to the Lands of Shadow

An Ultima III-Inspired Tactical Fantasy RPG

INSTALLATION & GETTING STARTED

There are two ways to play Realm of Shadow: download a pre-built release, or run directly from the Python source code. Both methods are described below.

Option 1: Downloading & Playing (macOS)

A pre-built macOS version is available on the Releases page. To get started:

1. Download the `.zip` file from the latest release:

https://github.com/mattjcamp/game_rpg_turn_based_open_world/releases

2. Unzip it — you'll get a folder called **RealmOfShadow**.

3. Before opening the game, you must clear the macOS quarantine flag. Open Terminal and run:

```
xattr -cr ~/Downloads/RealmOfShadow/
```

If you unzipped it somewhere other than Downloads, adjust the path — or drag the folder onto the Terminal window to fill it in automatically. You need to do this each time you download a new release.

4. Open the **RealmOfShadow** folder and double-click the file called **RealmOfShadow** (the one with no file extension) to launch the game.

First launch: *The game may take 10–20 seconds to appear the first time you run it while your system unpacks and caches the bundled libraries. Subsequent launches will be faster.*

"Damaged and can't be opened" error: *If you skipped step 3 and macOS says the app is damaged, don't worry — the file isn't actually damaged. macOS shows this message for any downloaded app that isn't notarized with Apple. Run the* `xattr -cr` *command from step 3 and try again.*

Option 2: Run from Python Source

If thou dost prefer to run from source (or wish to modify the game), follow these steps. Requires ***Python 3.10+****.*

1. Clone or download the repository:

https://github.com/mattjcamp/game_rpg_turn_based_open_world

2. Install the dependencies:

```
pip3 install -r requirements.txt
```

This installs **pygame** (≥2.5) and **numpy** (≥1.24).

3. Run the game:

```
python3 main.py
```

Building a Distributable Release

To create a standalone build that can be shared with others (no Python required):

1. Install PyInstaller: `pip3 install pyinstaller`

2. Run the build script from the project root: `python3 build_game.py`

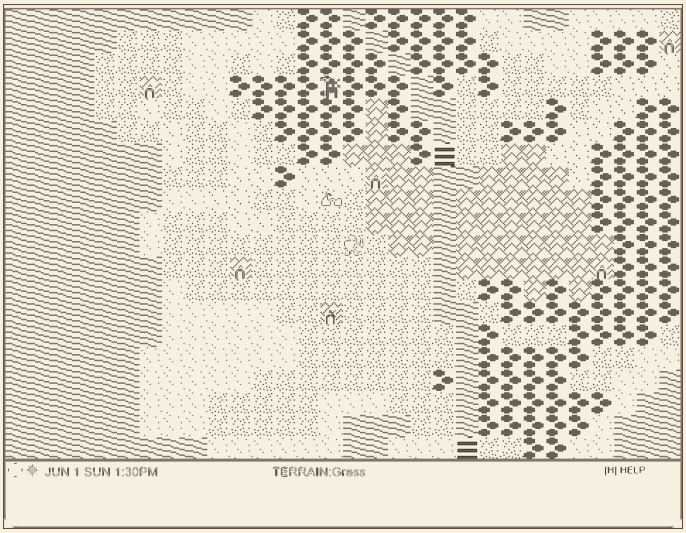
3. The finished build will appear in **dist/RealmOfShadow/**. Zip that folder and share it — recipients can run the game without installing Python.

For the latest updates, bug reports, and source code, visit the GitHub repository: github.com/mattjcamp/game_rpg_turn_based_open_world

Welcome, brave adventurer! Long have the lands of Shadow awaited a champion bold enough to face the darkness that gathers at the edge of the world. The people whisper of ancient evils stirring in forgotten dungeons, of cursed treasures guarded by creatures born of nightmare, and of a shadow that grows longer with each passing day.

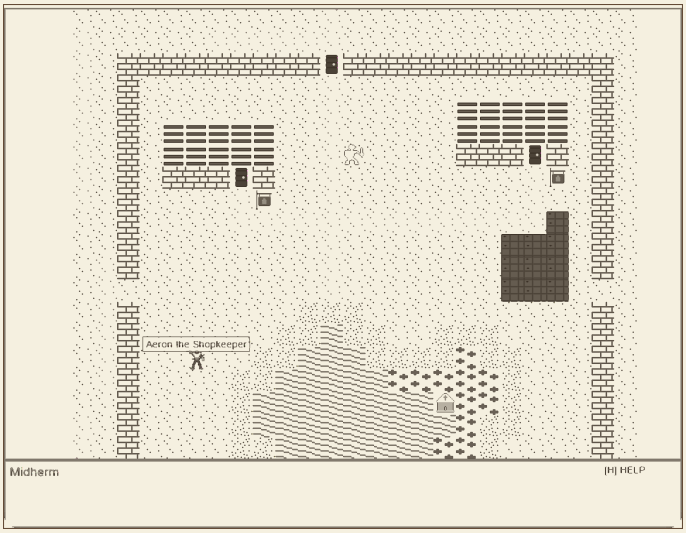
Realm of Shadow is a turn-based tactical RPG in the tradition of the classic Ultima games. Thou dost lead a party of up to four adventurers through a dangerous open world — exploring the overworld, delving into dungeons, trading in towns, and engaging in grid-based tactical combat against a host of enemies.

THE OVERWORLD



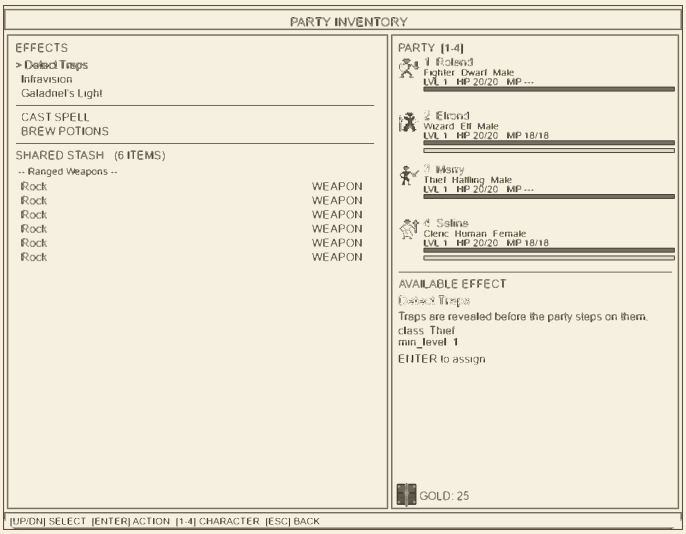
The overworld is a vast landscape of forests, mountains, rivers, and coastline. Roam freely across the map, discovering towns, dungeon entrances, and points of interest. Time passes as thou dost travel — day turns to night, and the seasons change. Beware: wandering monsters grow stronger the further thou dost venture from civilization.

TOWNS & COMMERCE



Towns offer respite from the dangers of the wilderness. Walk into an NPC to speak with them — merchants sell weapons, armor, and supplies; healers restore thy wounds; and quest-givers send thee on adventures for gold and glory. Speak to everyone, for some hold valuable clues to hidden treasures and secret passages.

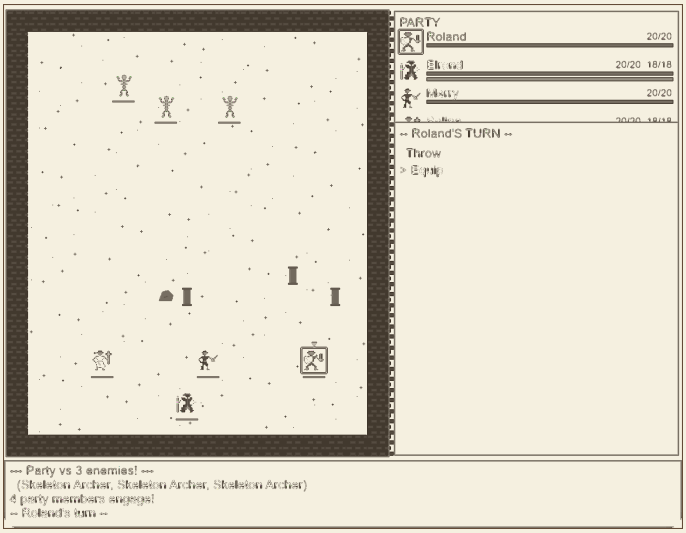
THY PARTY



Thy party shares a pool of gold and a communal inventory, but each character maintains their own equipped gear, hit points, magic points, and experience. The party inventory screen lets thee manage thy shared stash, cast spells outside of combat, brew potions, and review each companion's status at a glance.

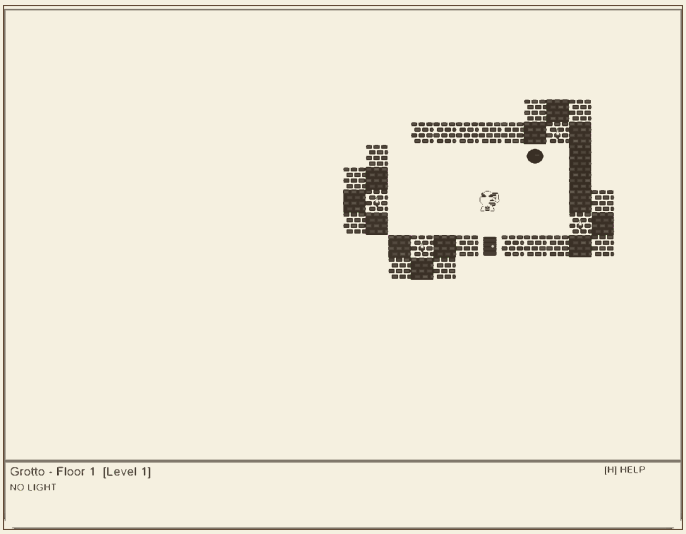
Choose thy party wisely — a balanced group with frontline fighters, healers, and spellcasters will fare better than one that leans too heavily upon a single role. ***The wilderness is unforgiving, and a lone adventurer rarely survives long.***

COMBAT



When combat is joined, the action moves to a tactical grid arena. Each character and monster takes individual turns based on initiative. Move with the WASD keys, attack by walking into foes, and fire ranged weapons with the arrow keys. Positioning matters — protect thy spellcasters behind a wall of fighters, and watch for flanking enemies.

DUNGEONS



Dungeons are multi-floor underground labyrinths filled with monsters, traps, treasure, and quest objectives. Lighting varies — some floors are well-lit by wall torches, while others are shrouded in darkness. Bring torches, a Light spell, or a Dwarf with Infravision to see thy way through the deepest halls.

Now that thou hast seen the shape of the world, let us prepare thee for the journey. In the pages that follow, thou shalt learn of the races and classes available to thy companions, the ways of combat, and the secrets of the realm.

THE RACES OF THE REALM

Five races walk the lands of Shadow, each possessing unique strengths and innate abilities. Thy choice of race will shape thy character's attributes and grant a special power that no training can replicate. Consider well which race best complements the profession thou hast in mind.

Human

Versatile and adaptable, excels in no single area but has no weaknesses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
+0	+0	+0	+0

Innate Ability — Fast Learner: Humans require only 750 XP per level instead of the standard 1000, allowing them to level up 25% faster than other races. This compensates for their lack of stat bonuses and makes them an excellent choice for any class.

Dwarf

Stout and hardy, natural miners and warriors with keen underground senses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
+2	-1	+0	+1

Innate Ability — Infravision: Dwarves can see in total darkness. Dungeon corridors that would be pitch-black to other races are dimly visible to a Dwarf, eliminating the need for a torch or Light spell.

Halfling

Small and nimble, surprisingly resilient and hard to hit.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-2	+2	+0	+1

Innate Ability — Pickpocket: Halflings can attempt to steal items from town NPCs. This ability has a daily cooldown and a chance of failure — use it wisely.

Elf

Graceful and keen-minded, with a natural affinity for magic and sharp senses.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-1	+1	+2	+0

Innate Ability — Galadriel's Light: Elves can conjure a soft magical illumination, lighting up dark areas without consuming a torch. This ability has a daily cooldown.

Gnome

Clever and curious, combining tinkering skill with innate magical talent.

STR	DEX	INT	WIS
-1	+0	+2	+1

Innate Ability — Tinker: Gnomes can repair broken equipment and craft simple items from reagents. This ability has a daily cooldown.

THE PROFESSIONS

Eight professions are available to the aspiring adventurer. Each determines thy character's combat prowess, magical abilities, allowed equipment, and special skills. The choice of profession is perhaps the most important decision thou wilt make, for it shapes the entire course of thy adventure.

TABLE 1

Characteristics of each Profession

	HP/Lvl	MP/Lvl	Range	Spell Type	Best Armor
Fighter	15	0	4	None	Plate
Wizard	4	15	2	Sorcerer	Cloth
Cleric	6	10	2	Priest	Chain
Thief	5	0	6	None	Leather
Paladin	10	5	4	Priest	Plate
Ranger	10	3	4	Priest	Chain
Druid	5	12	2	Both	Cloth
Alchemist	4	8	4	Sorcerer	Cloth

Fighter

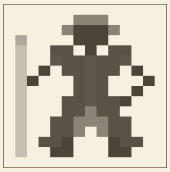
The quintessential warrior — tough, versatile, and deadly in melee.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
15	0	4	None

Allowed Weapons: All weapons

Allowed Armor: All armor (Cloth, Leather, Chain, Plate)

Fighters are the backbone of any party. With the highest HP per level, a generous 4-tile combat range, and access to every weapon and armor type, they belong on the front line where the fighting is thickest. They wield no magic but more than compensate with raw staying power and devastating damage output.



Wizard

Master of arcane forces — fragile but devastatingly powerful at range.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
4	15	2	Sorcerer

Allowed Weapons: Fists, Dagger

Allowed Armor: Cloth only

Wizards command the most diverse and powerful spell list in the game. From Fireball to Lightning Bolt, Charm Person to Animate Dead, they reshape the battlefield. Their weakness is severe — the lowest HP per level, no armor, and only daggers for weapons. Keep them behind thy front line and let them rain destruction from safety.

Arcane Focus — Spell damage is increased by the Intelligence modifier.

Cleric

Holy warrior and healer — the party's lifeline in long fights.

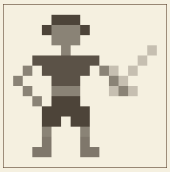
HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
6	10	2	Priest

Allowed Weapons: Fists, Club, Mace, Sling

Allowed Armor: Cloth, Leather, Chain

Clerics are the primary healers of the party. Minor Heal, Major Heal, Mass Heal, and the ultimate Restore spell keep everyone standing, while Cure Poison removes dangerous status effects. They can also fight respectably in melee with maces and clubs, wear chain armor, and devastate undead with Turn Undead. Every party should have one.

Turn Undead (Level 2+) — Channels holy energy that strips 50% of HP from all undead enemies on the battlefield.



Thief

Quick, cunning, and deadly from the shadows — unmatched utility.

HP/Level	MP/Level	Range	Spell Type
5	0	6	None

Allowed Weapons: Fists, Dagger, Club, Sling, Short Bow

Allowed Armor: Cloth, Leather

The Thief has the longest combat range of any class (6 tiles), making them effective skirmishers who can outmaneuver most opponents. With a Short Bow they can pelt enemies from a safe distance. At Level 3, Backstab turns the humble Dagger into a devastating weapon. At Level 7, Shadow Step transforms them into true hit-and-run fighters. Their real value outside combat is Pick Locks and Detect Traps, which open up areas and loot that other classes cannot reach.

Pick Locks — Open locked doors and chests. **Backstab** (Level 3+) — Critical hits with daggers on a DEX save. **Shadow Step** (Level 7+) — Move after attacking.

COMBAT

Combat takes place on an 18 × 21 tile grid arena. All four party members and all enemy monsters are placed on the grid and take individual turns. Each character may independently control their actions — moving, fighting, or casting spells.

At the start of combat, every combatant rolls initiative: d20 + DEX modifier. Higher rolls act first. Thy party members take turns in order, then all monsters act, then the cycle repeats. When a character attacks, the game rolls d20 + Attack Bonus against the target's Armor Class. A natural 1 always misses. A natural 20 always hits and doubles the damage dice. Be careful of thy positioning — monsters can attack on diagonals while characters can only strike in cardinal directions.

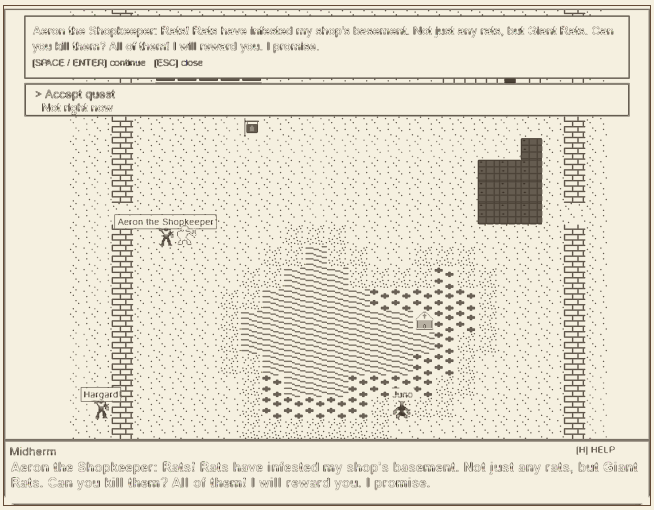
Movement:

During their turn, a character may move using the WASD keys. Each class has a base movement range. Walk into an adjacent enemy to trigger a melee attack. Use the arrow keys to fire ranged weapons in cardinal directions. Press spacebar to skip thy turn and defend, gaining +2 AC until thy next turn.

Status Effects:

Effect	Duration	Description
Sleep	3-5 turns	Target skips all turns; broken by damage
Poison	4 turns	Takes damage at start of each turn
Curse	3-5 turns	-2 AC and -2 attack penalty
Charm	3 turns	Humanoid monster fights for the party
Invisible	3 turns	Monsters cannot target the character
Blessed	4 turns	+2 attack bonus for all allies
Shielded	3 turns	+1 AC bonus

QUESTS & ADVENTURES



A shopkeeper in the town of Midherm pleads for help with a rat infestation. Speak to townsfolk to discover quests and earn rewards.

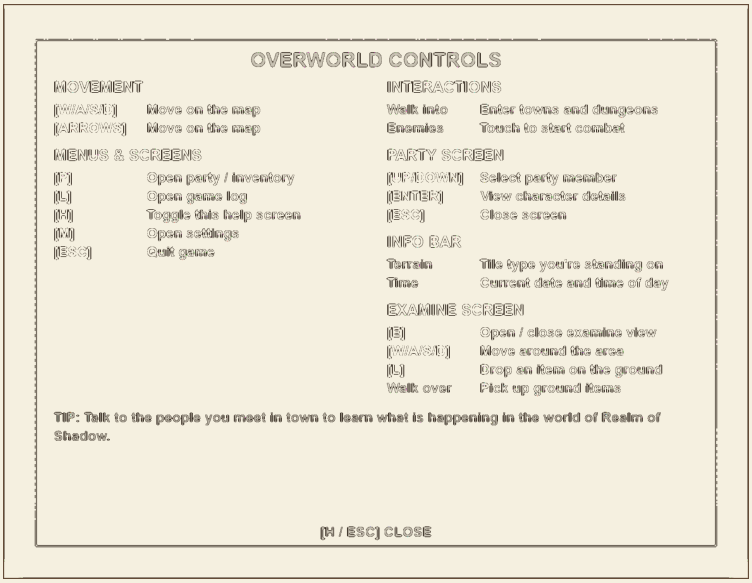
The dungeons have, of late, become particularly treacherous and deadly. Explore carefully and slowly. Secret doors abound throughout the different dungeons. Magical winds howl down the corridors, blowing out all light. If thou walks slowly, glimpses of faint mystic writings may be noticed periodically.

There also exist many traps and pitfalls for the unwary. A Thief is an excellent choice to have in a party. If the party puts the Thief at the front, thou wilt have an excellent chance of spotting traps before they are sprung. Many strange and wonderful places are hidden within different dungeons, such as fountains. Some fountains are beneficial, while others are poisonous. Always drink carefully at a fountain.

The towns of the realm offer respite from the dangers of the wilderness. Walk into an NPC to speak with them — merchants, healers, and quest-givers all have wisdom to share and goods to trade. Speak to all of them, for some hold valuable clues to the locations of hidden items and secret passages.

Bare is the back who hast not kin to protect it! Decide quickly — equip thy party with the finest weapons and armor thy purse can afford. The party's ability to survive depends as much on the quality of its equipment as on the quality of its leader. Forget not to obtain enough Food, for towns are widely scattered and starvation is always so unpleasant to watch.

CONTROLS & COMMANDS



*The in-game help screen. Press **[H]** at any time on the overworld to view this reference.*

The following commands are available whilst exploring the overworld. Commit them to memory, for swift action is often the difference between life and death.

Key	Action
W / A / S / D	Move on the overworld map
Arrow Keys	Move on the overworld map (alternate)
P	Open party inventory screen
L	Open game log
H	Toggle help screen
M	Open settings
E	Open / close examine view
ESC	Quit game

Interactions:

*Walk into a town entrance or dungeon entrance to enter. Walk into an NPC to speak with them. Walk into an enemy on the overworld to initiate combat. In the examine view, use **[W/A/S/D]** to look around, **[L]** to drop items, and walk over ground items to pick them up.*

Party Screen:

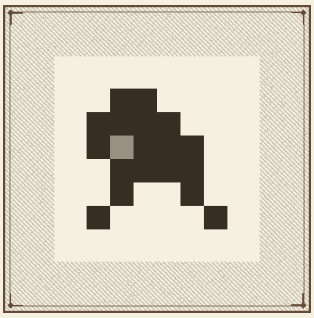
*Press **[P]** to open the party inventory. Use **[Up/Down]** to select a party member, **[Enter]** to view character details, and **[ESC]** to close the screen.*

Combat Controls:

*During combat, use **[W/A/S/D]** to move thy character on the tactical grid. Walk into an adjacent enemy to strike with a melee weapon. Press the **[Arrow Keys]** to fire a ranged weapon in that direction. Press **[Spacebar]** to defend, gaining +2 AC until thy next turn. Press **[1–4]** during the loot phase to switch which party member collects treasure.*

BESTIARY

The lands of Shadow teem with dangerous creatures, from vermin in the cellars to terrible beasts lurking in the deepest dungeon halls. Herein is a field guide to the monsters thou shalt encounter on thy journey. Study it well, for knowledge of thine enemy is the first step toward victory.



GIANT RAT

A common pest found in basements and dungeon tunnels. Weak alone, but they attack in swarms.

HP: 8 • AC: 12 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d4

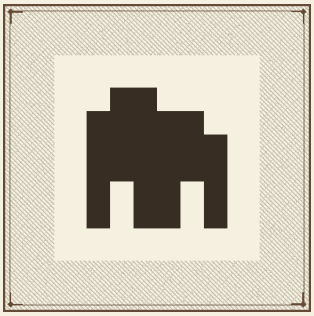
Found in dungeons and house basements. Swarms of rats are a frequent first encounter for new adventurers. They pose little individual threat but can overwhelm the careless.

GOBLIN

Small, sneaky creatures that attack in groups. They carry thrown rocks for ranged harassment.

HP: 6 • AC: 11 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d4

Ranged: Thrown rock (range 4, 1d3). Goblins are cowardly but cunning — they prefer to pelt the party from a distance and flee when cornered.

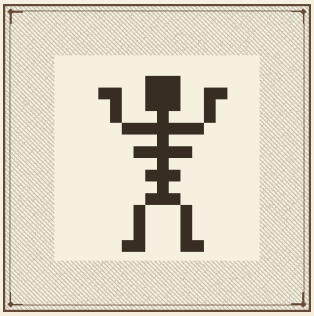


WOLF

Fierce grey wolves that hunt in packs. Fast and cunning.

HP: 12 • AC: 13 • Attack: +4 • Damage: 1d6+1

Found roaming the overworld and in dungeon corridors. Wolves are swift and dangerous in numbers. Keep thy formation tight.

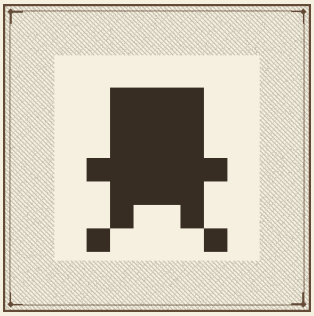


SKELETON

Undead warriors animated by dark magic. Vulnerable to Turn Undead and holy weapons.

HP: 16 • AC: 13 • Attack: +3 • Damage: 1d6+1

Undead — takes massive damage from Turn Undead. A Cleric is invaluable against these foes. Found in dungeons throughout the realm.

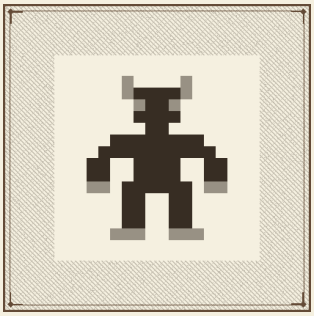


ZOMBIE

Shambling corpses — slow but surprisingly durable. They just keep coming.

HP: 20 • AC: 10 • Attack: +2 • Damage: 1d6+1

Undead — vulnerable to Turn Undead. Zombies are slow but absorb punishment that would fell lesser creatures. Cleave through them quickly.

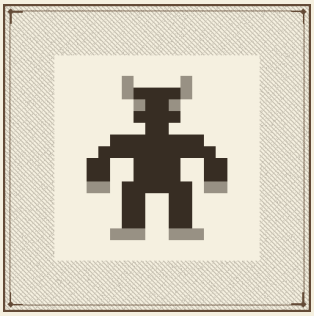


ORC

Brutal and well-armed warriors. A serious threat, especially in groups.

HP: 22 • AC: 13 • Attack: +5 • Damage: 1d8+2

Ranged: Javelin (range 3, 1d6+1). Humanoid — can be charmed. Orcs are among the most dangerous common enemies in the realm.

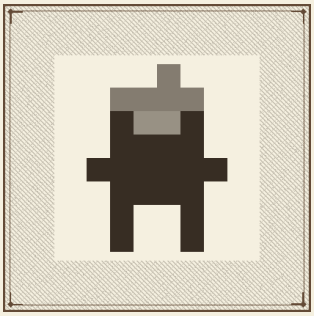


ORC SHAMAN

An orc witch doctor who bolsters allies with healing magic and poisons foes.

HP: 16 • AC: 11 • Attack: +3 • Damage: 1d4

Casts Mend Wounds to heal allies and Poison Spit to weaken the party. Eliminate shamans first to prevent them from healing their warriors.

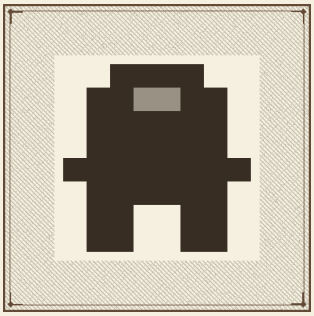


DARK MAGE

A robed figure crackling with dark energy. Attacks from range and casts debilitating spells.

HP: 14 • AC: 12 • Attack: +4 • Damage: 2d4+1

Ranged: Dark bolt (range 7, 2d4+1). Casts Dark Slumber and Hex. Close distance quickly — their ranged attacks are devastating.

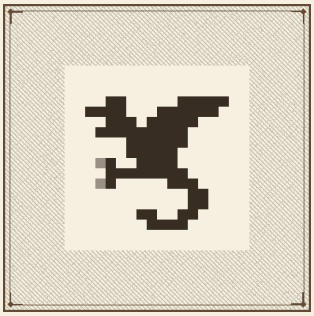


TROLL

A massive brute with thick hide. Hits incredibly hard and regenerates health each turn.

HP: 30 • AC: 14 • Attack: +6 • Damage: 2d6+2

Regenerates 1d6+2 HP per turn. Focus fire to overwhelm its regeneration. A Curse spell can reduce its devastating damage output.



DRAGON

An ancient wyrm of terrible power. The most fearsome creature in the realm.

HP: 60 • AC: 18 • Attack: +10 • Damage: 3d8+4

Ranged: Fire breath (range 5, 4d6 damage in a cone). The Dragon is the deadliest foe thou shalt face. It strikes with devastating claws and breathes searing flame that scorches all in its path. Only the most powerful and well-prepared parties should dare challenge a Dragon. Bring thy strongest weapons, healing magic, and courage.

THE ARCANE & DIVINE ARTS

Spells consume Magic Points (MP) and are divided into two schools: Sorcerer and Priest. Each class may only cast spells from its allowed school. The Druid alone draws from both traditions. Thy MP pool is determined by thy class and the relevant attribute — Intelligence for Sorcerers, Wisdom for Priests.

Magic Point Sources:

Class	Attribute	Rate	School
Wizard	Intelligence	100%	Sorcerer
Cleric	Wisdom	100%	Priest
Paladin	Wisdom	50%	Priest
Ranger	Wisdom	50%	Priest
Alchemist	Intelligence	50%	Sorcerer
Druid	INT or WIS	50% (2× regen)	Both

SORCERER SPELLS

These spells are available to Wizards, Alchemists, and Druids. New spells unlock at every level — higher-level spells are more powerful but require more MP to cast.

Spell	Lvl	MP	Effect
Magic Dart	1	3	1d6 + INT mod damage (single target projectile)
Shield	1	4	+1 AC to target for 3 turns
Sleep	1	5	Puts target to sleep (2 turns, save DC 8 + INT)
Long Shanks	2	6	+4 movement range to target for 3 turns
Knock	2	6	Unlocks a locked door (d20 + INT vs DC 12)
Magic Arrow	3	8	3d8 + INT mod damage (piercing bolt)
Misty Step	4	8	Teleport to a chosen location on the battlefield
Invisibility	4	16	Caster becomes invisible for 3 turns
Charm Person	5	14	Humanoid fights for you (3 turns, save DC 12 + INT)
Lightning Bolt	5	15	6d6 + INT mod damage in a straight line
Animate Dead	6	20	Summon a skeleton ally for 5 turns
Fireball	7	25	5d8 + INT mod in 3-tile radius (hits allies!)

Warning: *Fireball is the game's most devastating spell, but it hits everything in its radius — including thine own party members! Position carefully before casting.*

PRIEST SPELLS

These spells are available to Clerics, Paladins, Rangers, and Druids. Priest magic focuses on healing, protection, and turning the undead.

Spell	Lvl	MP	Effect
Minor Heal	1	3	Heals 1d6 + WIS mod HP (usable outside combat)
Light	1	3	Illuminates dungeon corridors for 100 turns
Cure Poison	2	5	Removes poison from target
Turn Undead	2	8	Strips 50% HP from all undead on the battlefield
Bless	3	10	+2 attack bonus to all allies for 4 turns
Curse	3	10	–2 AC and –2 attack on target for 4 turns
Major Heal	4	15	Heals 4d8 + WIS mod HP
Push	5	14	Repels monsters in a 5-tile radius
Mass Heal	6	25	Heals 3d10 + WIS mod HP to all nearby allies
Restore	7	35	Fully restores HP and MP for all allies, cures all poisons

Tip: *Minor Heal and Light are usable outside of combat. Keep thy healers' MP stocked for between-fight patching up. At Level 1, thy MP pool is small — save it for when it counts.*

Warning: *Restore is the Cleric's ultimate spell — it fully heals the entire party's HP and MP and cures all poisons, but at 35 MP it costs half the Cleric's total pool at Level 7, and the caster's own MP is not restored.*

Thou art now as prepared as possible to face the trials of thy quest. Drink deep of the fellowship of thy companions, for the morrow may bring thy parting. Journey onward, and may the Gods of the People grant thou victory!